

RECONSTRUCTION

SHORT TUNIC

Typically worn in the Saxon era, this short ungored (without panel inserts) tunic has been re-created in grey lozenge-twill wool by reconstruction dressmaker Sarah Thursfield. Short tunics were worn by young men and workers from the 3rd or 4th century CE in northern Germany right through to late Saxon times. Tunics based on rectangles and triangles were the basic unit of clothing across Europe. They were usually worn with *braccas* (wool trousers), often with leg windings, and leather shoes. The final appearance of a tunic was a matter of personal preference and style: the wearer arranged the spare width of the fabric over the tied fabric belt, gently pouched or sometimes in the stylish pleats seen in late Saxon illustrations. Later tunics often had fuller gored skirts.



◁ RURAL WEAR

A peasant tends his sheep in a rural idyll on a late Anglo-Saxon vellum. He wears a simple tunic draped over a fabric belt – a style and shape that endured for centuries.



Fullness at top of arms allows freedom of movement

No armhole shaping

Full-length sleeves

Short skirt pouched over belt

◁ SIMPLE CONSTRUCTION

The tunic back and front are made from two unshaped rectangles of cloth with added sleeves that taper at the wrist. A fabric belt defines the waist and gathers in the width.